



TONALITY

"Only 7% of communication is actually the words you use."

— ALBERT MEHRABIAN

The script is the words. Tonality is the meaning.



TONALITY

Sales Basics — Reference

THE 12 TONES

01	Curious	07	Reasonable
02	Confused / Skeptical	08	Obvious
03	Casual	09	Genuine / Sincere
04	Concerned	10	Familiar
05	Certain	11	Playful
06	Intrigue / Mystery	12	Scarcity / Urgency

THE POWER OF TONALITY

7% of communication is
the words you say.

The other 93% is how you say them and how you carry yourself while you're saying them. That's why two reps can run the exact same script and get completely different results — same words, different delivery, different outcome.

The script gives you the words. Tonality gives them meaning. Get the tone right and the script works. Get it wrong and the script does nothing for you.

THE 12 TONES — IN DETAIL

When to use it. What you're going for. How it lands in the script.

CURIOUS

When to use

Most questions in the script. Anywhere you're asking the prospect for information or wondering aloud.

Goal

Signal genuine interest, not interrogation. Slight upward inflection but soft — you actually want to know the answer, not collect data to pitch back at them.

Example from script

"How come you guys haven't got solar yet?"

CONFUSED / SKEPTICAL

When to use

The "old man" tone. Disarming opener moments, anywhere you want to lower your perceived authority.

Goal

Lower the prospect's guard. Confused reps don't feel like a threat — the prospect's pitch-defence doesn't fire. Skeptical pulls them in too: makes them want to explain or convince you. Both flip the dynamic so they're leading.

Example from script

"Hey are you guys the... homeowners here?"

CASUAL

When to use

Probably the most common tone in the entire script. Default delivery for the body of the pitch.

Goal

Strip out any pressure or intensity. Sound like a neighbour having a chat, not a salesperson running a script. Calm beats keen every time.

Example from script

"I've just got an appointment in a couple of minutes literally just down the road."

CONCERNED

When to use

On big bills, on "you might not even qualify," and on lines where you're noting something genuinely off for them.

Goal

Signal you're on their side. Slight wince in the voice. Don't overdo it — concerned, not theatrical. The prospect should feel that you understand the pain, not that you're performing.

Example from script

"Wowwww you're getting smashed."

CERTAIN

When to use

When stating how the system works, the mechanics of the offer, or anything they need to walk away believing.

Goal

Belief in what you're saying, no doubt, steady and level. The opposite of certainty is hesitation — and hesitation kills credibility. If you don't sound sure, they won't be either.

Example from script

"You can actually put a system on the roof for literally 0 cost."

INTRIGUE / MYSTERY

When to use

Setting up the reveal of the offer. Anywhere you want them to lean in.

Goal

Pull them in. Slight pulled-back delivery, like there's something worth hearing next. The prospect should be the one wanting more information, not you giving it away.

Example from script

"There is a genuine reason I'm here, I'll show you."

REASONABLE

When to use

Throughout the body of the pitch. Anywhere you're explaining the logic of what you're proposing.

Goal

"This just makes sense" energy. Calm, logical, not pushing. Lets the prospect arrive at the conclusion themselves rather than feeling sold to.

Example from script

"You can just redirect it to pay off the system."

OBVIOUS

When to use

Anywhere you want them to see the answer is self-evident — usually paired with a shrug.

Goal

"Of course" energy. Gets the prospect nodding along because the conclusion feels too obvious to argue with. Stops them looking for reasons to push back.

Example from script

"No one's opposed to just having a chat."

GENUINE / SINCERE

When to use

Hand-on-heart moments. Disarmers like "I'm not here to sell you anything." Sincere is the heavier version, used when giving your word.

Goal

Strip away every trace of agenda. The prospect needs to believe — at the bone — that you mean exactly what you're saying. Eye contact locked, voice level, no salesperson varnish.

Example from script

"I'm not here to sell you anything today at all."

FAMILIAR

When to use

On the neighbour proof. Anywhere you're referencing someone like you actually know them.

Goal

Sound like you're talking about a real person you've genuinely met. Warm, relaxed recognition. The prospect picks up on whether the name is real or fake within a second based on this tone alone.

Example from script

"I just finished helping out [NEIGHBOUR] a couple blocks over."

PLAYFUL

When to use

Anywhere there's a chuckle in the script. Often layered on top of another tone — playful + casual, playful + confused, playful + reasonable.

Goal

Take the edge off. A small chuckle signals "this isn't serious, no pressure here," which keeps the conversation light and stops the prospect bracing for a pitch.

Example from script

"It's not like you've signed into some 25-year contract or something crazy."

SCARCITY / URGENCY

When to use

On the "almost done with the area" line and any time-sensitive promo language.

Goal

Time-sensitive without sounding pushy. "Something just came across my desk" energy — calm, factual, almost muttered. The moment urgency sounds announced or theatrical, it reads as pressure and the prospect resists. Calm urgency lands. Loud urgency doesn't.

Example from script

"You'd probably be one of the last few we get to."
